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San Fernando Valley - Awards recognize those in service to Valley - Honorees include civic, community leaders, activists, educators and business owners

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State Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel, D-Woodland Hills, hosted a special awards ceremony on Thursdayrecognizing achievements and contributions of 13 individuals and organizations who helped to make the San Fernando Valley a better place to live over the past year.

The honorees included activists, civic and community leaders, educators and small-business owners. Gabriel presented special California state Legislature resolutions acknowledging their community work in San Fernando Valley.

The 2022 honorees

• Pierre Arreola, co-founder of GR818ERS, 2022 Mentor of the Year.

• Marc Berkman and Ed Peisner, CEO and national director of education for Organization for Social Media Safety, 2022 Nonprofit of the Year.

• Abbie and Reggie Cua, owners of Cafe Aficionado, 2022 Small Business of the Year.

• Adnan Hamid, board member for the Dawoodi Bohra community of Los Angeles, 2022 Community Volunteer of the Year.

• Dina Kimmel, founder of We Rock the Spectrum

Kids Gym and My Brother Rocks the Spectrum Foundation, 2022 Woman of the Year

• Maktab Tarighat Oveyssi (M.T.O.) Shahmaghsoudi, 2022 Community Heroes of the Year

• Dale and Monique Mascari, owners of Grocery Outlet — Canoga Park, 2022 Businesspersons of the Year

• Serena Oberstein, CEO at Jewish World Watch, 2022 Activist of the Year

• Planned Parenthood Health Center — Canoga Park, 2022 Community Heroes of the Year

• El Proyecto del Barrio, 2022 Community Heroes of the Year

• Wendy Wooten, PhD, teacher at Reseda Charter High School, 2022 Educator of the Year

• Diana Weynand, chair of the San Fernando Valley Chapter of Climate Reality Project, 2022 Environmentalist of the Year

• Mike Young, political and organizing director of EnviroVoters, 2022 Environmentalist of the Year

The ceremony took place at the Local Peasant in Woodland Hills.

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